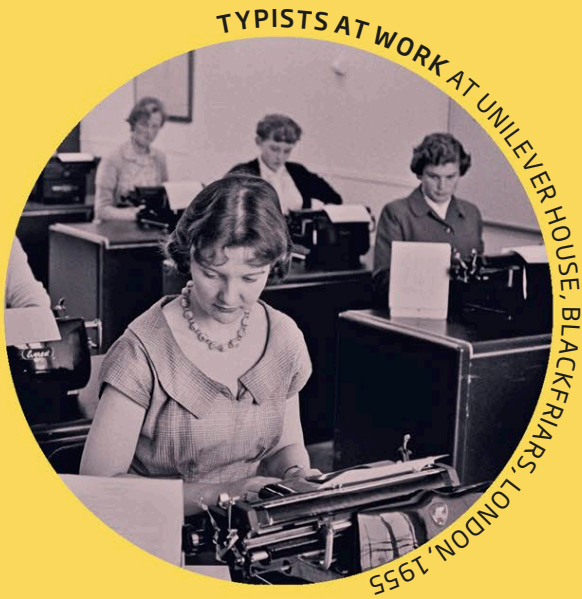




pointed black hats to make them easy to identify when selling their wares. They also put brooms outside of their homes to show that beer was being sold, the combination of these features later became synonymous with witchcraft (see pp. 122–123). Alewives were often the first targets for accusations of witchcraft, perhaps because they were women with some financial autonomy.

In the 19th and 20th centuries, women's work in towns and factories led to the formation of specifically female trade unions. The first such example was that of the Lowell Mill girls in Massachusetts, who went on strike to protest against low wages and dangerous working conditions in 1844; in 1866, African American laundresses in Mississippi followed their example. Bigger unions soon arrived: national Women's Trade Union Leagues were formed at the turn of the 20th century in Britain and the US to advocate for the rights of female workers. Such unions later supported women who went on strike for equal pay (see pp. 272–275).

The professions

Throughout history, many roles were divided along gender lines. While men working in labor-oriented jobs have been called “blue collar” workers (in opposition to “white

“Our **wages** weren't for **pin money**. They were to **help with** the **cost of living**, to pay your **mortgage** and ... your **bills**.”

GWEN DAVIS, PARTICIPANT IN THE 1968 FORD STRIKE, UK

collar” workers in office and professional positions), the term “pink collar” refers to women in careers that have traditionally been considered women's work. Pink collar jobs include “unskilled” work such as babysitting or retail work, as well as jobs in the beauty industry (as hairdressers or nail technicians) or typing and secretarial work. While many require training, pink collar jobs pay low wages and carry little prestige because of their designation as “women's work.”

The 20th century brought more women into traditionally “male” professions, and now women are slowly infiltrating the highest levels of industry. However, women still only make up approximately five percent of CEOs of Fortune 500 companies.

“A **truly equal world** would be one where **women ran half** our countries and **companies** and men **ran half our homes**.”

SHERYL SANDBERG, *LEAN IN: WOMEN, WORK, AND THE WILL TO LEAD*, 2013